

Derrick Auyoung

Pro Workflow Architect / Creative Systems & Pipelines

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 - Portfolio: <https://derrickauyoung.github.io/aboutderrick/>
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SUMMARY

Workflow architect and technical leader with deep experience designing creative production workflows across animation, VFX, real-time engines, and cloud-hosted systems. Known for bridging creative intent, engineering constraints, and system reliability. Recently investigated agent-based systems via a hands-on capstone project to assess how AI-driven orchestration can improve workflow efficiency and delegation of repetitive tasks.

CORE EXPERTISE

Creative & Production Workflow Architecture • Media & Animation Pipelines •
Cross-Disciplinary Technical Leadership • Performance-Aware Systems Design •
Tooling Strategy & Roadmapping • Python & C++ • Unreal Engine Integration •
Cloud-Deployed Services • Artist-Centric UX Thinking

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Wētā FX – Engagement Supervisor & Staff Software Engineer, Domain Technology

Wellington, NZ / Remote, CA US | Oct 2024 - Present

- Developed and maintained 130+ Python and C++ tools and services supporting animation and adjacent creative departments.
- Supported workflows used by 200-250 artists across animation and related disciplines.
- Contributed to show-critical pipelines used in active feature film, episodic, and mixed media productions.
- Partnered with production and engineering teams to evolve pipelines with a focus on usability, stability, and long-term maintainability.
- Acted as primary liaison between 10+ production and 5+ engineering teams, translating creative workflows into actionable technical plans.

- Led cross-disciplinary efforts across 8 active support workflows to reduce workflow friction and code duplication during organizational transition.
 - Championed root-cause analysis to identify and address recurring pipeline issues, reducing support load across 1500+ artists and production crew.
 - Improved perceived tool reliability and user confidence based on sustained production feedback.
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Wētā Digital / Unity – Head of Motion R&D

Wellington, NZ | May 2016 – Oct 2024

- Set strategy and long-term direction for motion and animation technology across multiple blockbuster franchises including *Avatar*, *Planet of the Apes*, *Avengers*, real-time, and experimental projects.
 - Owned animation technology roadmaps and supported 40+ major film/episodic productions, balancing immediate needs with future-facing capabilities.
 - People managed a team of 15 engineers and 2 team leads delivering core animation and motion tooling used across multiple feature film productions over 8+ years.
 - Guided migration of VFX animation pipeline data into Unreal Engine for real-time experiences including *The Matrix Awakens*, *Fortnite*, and *Overwatch* shorts.
 - Monitored usage metrics and qualitative feedback to drive iterative improvements rather than one-off tooling solutions.
 - Communicated complex workflow and system tradeoffs to executives and senior stakeholders to drive alignment and investment.
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Wētā Digital – Lead Animation TD / Animator

Wellington, NZ | Nov 2006 – May 2016

- Designed and maintained animation tools and publishing workflows used by 120-200 animators across multiple productions.
 - Worked directly with animators to test and refine tools based on real production usage.
 - Established animation-to-motion-capture workflows, across 2 global motion capture stages in NZ and LA, ensuring accurate timecode synchronization across capture hardware and motion media to maintain consistency between performance capture, animation, and downstream pipeline stages.
 - Led development of *Chronos*, a next-generation motion pipeline built on new scene description concepts and adopted across 300+ artists and 6+ departments.
 - Contributed as a character animator on *Rise of the Planet of the Apes*.
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Rhythm & Hues Studios – Lead Animation Layout TD / Animator / Pipeline TD

Los Angeles, CA | Jun 2003 – Nov 2006

- Built tools to streamline layout and animation workflows across multiple feature films.

- Improved scene assembly and data flow under tight production schedules.
 - Contributed as an animator on *Night at the Museum*.
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SELECTED PROJECTS

My Meal Planner – Agentic Workflow System

Kaggle × Google AI Agents Intensive - Capstone Project, Dec 2025

- Architected a multi-agent workflow (3 agents) using Google ADK to orchestrate planning, data normalization, and summarization tasks.
- Implemented and deployed a cloud-hosted service for real end-users via a React-based web interface.
- Implemented explicit agent lifecycle management to prevent unnecessary compute usage and control cloud costs.
- Designed for daily real-world use.

Repository: <https://github.com/derrickauyoung/mymealplanner>

CERTIFICATIONS

- **5-Day AI Agents Intensive Course with Google** — Kaggle, Dec 2025
 - **Certified Unity Hiring Manager** — Social Talent, Apr 2023
 - **Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO)** — Scrum Alliance, Aug 2021
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EDUCATION

UCLA — B.S. in Computer Science, 1999-2003

Minor: Design I Media Arts (Film & Computer Animation)